

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- New HollowFrame loader and Matryoshka malware family discovered
- Fuyao operation uses Android TV boxes for ad fraud
- Interpol's I-GRIP mechanism intercepts millions in fraud attempts
- AI chatbots outperform humans in building trust for scams
- Amgen says cloud data breach exposed patient health, proprietary info

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. New HollowFrame loader and Matryoshka malware family discovered

The attack chain begins with a spear-phishing email containing a link to an encrypted archive.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/new-hollowframe-loader-and-matryoshka-malware-family-discovered>

02. Arch Linux disables AUR package adoption to stop malware flood

The Arch Linux project has temporarily disabled adoption of Arch User Repository (AUR) packages after a surge in malicious takeovers of existing packages. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/arch-linux-disables-aur-package-adoption-to-stop-malware-flood/>

03. CaptiveCrunch: Midnight Blizzard targets travelers worldwide for malware delivery and credential theft

Storm-2945, a sub-cluster of the Russian threat actor Midnight Blizzard, has been observed compromising the sign-in portals of hospitality-related organizations such as hotels since May 2026 in order to deliver malware to travelers and steal credentials in an operation we call CaptiveCrunch. The post CaptiveCrunch: Midnight Blizzard targets travelers worldw...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/07/31/captivecrunch-midnight-blizzard-targets-travelers-worldwide-for-malware-delivery-and-credential-theft/>

04. 2026-07-31: SmartApeSG ClickFix campaign pushes unidentified RAT

2026-07-31: SmartApeSG ClickFix campaign pushes unidentified RAT

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.malware-traffic-analysis.net/2026/07/31/index.html>

05. HollowFrame Loader Deploys Matryoshka Backdoor in Spear-Phishing Attack on Law Firm

Cybersecurity researchers have shed light on a previously undocumented Go-based loader framework called HollowFrame and a Rust-based malware family tracked as Matryoshka. According to Blackpoint Cyber, the intrusion sequence begins with a spear-phishing message containing a link to an encrypted archive, which holds a Windows Shortcut (LNK). Executing the fi...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/hollowframe-loader-deploys-matryoshka.html>

06. ESET tracks rise in malicious AI skills and adaptable malware

Attackers are adapting established techniques to AI platforms, emerging technologies, and changing user behavior. ESET's new threat report examines the rise of malicious AI skills, AI-assisted malware, ClickFix attacks, record quishing activity, and ransomware tools designed to disable security software. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/eset-tracks-rise-in-malicious-ai-skills-and-adaptable-malware/>

07. 6 Reasons Why Device Code Phishing is the Fastest-Growing Threat of 2026

Device code phishing - the abuse of the OAuth 2.0 device authorization grant to steal access tokens - has evolved from a niche red-team technique to an industrial-scale threat in under six months. Designed for input-constrained devices like smart TVs, printers, and so on, the device authorization login flow has been adopted by a wide range of apps and use-c...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/6-reasons-why-device-code-phishing-is.html>

08. Fake Flash Player installs AtlasRAT

Researchers have uncovered a new campaign that spreads the AtlasRAT remote access Trojan by disguising it as a Flash Player installer.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/news/2026/07/fake-flash-player-installs-atlasrat>

09. The Xcode Assassin Returns: A Deep Dive Into the Latest XCSSET Version

Analysis of XCSSET v40 reveals a macOS malware targeting developers via Xcode. Unit 42 used advanced pattern matching and AI to decode its logic. The post The Xcode Assassin Returns: A Deep Dive Into the Latest XCSSET Version appeared first on Unit 42 .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/xcsset-v40-malware-analysis/>

10. [+24h Old] AWS Blames North Korean Group for Axios and Other npm Supply Chain Attacks

AWS has linked North Korea to the axios campaign to other attacks on npm libraries

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/aws-north-korea-axios-npm-supply/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Interpol's I-GRIP mechanism intercepts millions in fraud attempts

The I-GRIP initiative connects law enforcement agencies across 196 countries with financial institutions to expedite the process of stopping fraudulent money transfers.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/interpols-i-grip-mechanism-intercepts-millions-in-fraud-attempts>

02. Hacker uses DeepSeek AI to autonomously attack vulnerable servers

A Chinese-speaking threat actor is using the DeepSeek AI model and the open-source Hermes Agent to conduct autonomous cyberattacks on exposed servers with limited human involvement. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hacker-uses-deepseek-ai-to-autonomously-attack-vulnerable-servers/>

03. In Other News: OpenAI Open Source Tool, AWS Links Hacks to North Korea, Mythos Crypto Research

Noteworthy stories that might have slipped under the radar: parcel delivery company OnTrac hacked, Adobe patches, UK Department for Education loses 607,000 records. The post In Other News: OpenAI Open Source Tool, AWS Links Hacks to North Korea, Mythos Crypto Research appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/in-other-news-openai-open-source-tool-aws-links-hacks-to-north-korea-mythos-crypto-research/>

04. VU#243636: VPS.org one-click deployment templates contain multiple vulnerabilities

Overview VPS.org's one-click deployment templates provision services with default passwords and predefined network bindings instead of generating randomized secrets or applying per-deployment hardening measures. Description VPS.org is a cloud and virtual private server hosting provider that offers a library of templates for quickly provisioning common appli...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://kb.cert.org/vuls/id/243636>

05. Broadcom patches vulnerabilities all over VMware

Broadcom has addresses five vulnerabilities in its VMware product range, three of which have been accorded a "critical" rating. The affected products are: VMware ESX, VMware vCenter, VMware Workstation, VMware Fusion, VMware Cloud Foundation, VMware vSphere Foundation, VMware Telco Cloud Platform, and VMware Telco Cloud Infrastructure CVE-2026-59309 affects...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.csoonline.com/article/4203947/broadcom-patches-vulnerabilities-all-over-vmware.html>

06. Interpol Leverages Global System to Curtail Fraud Payments

When a fraudulent transaction occurs, law enforcement agencies must work quickly to halt payments before cybercriminals cash out.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cybersecurity-operations/interpol-leverages-global-system-curtail-fraud-payments>

07. Microsoft almost gave away the keys to everyone's Azure Cosmos DBs

Microsoft has had a narrow escape from total embarrassment: A security company uncovered a critical vulnerability that could have compromised all Azure Cosmos DB databases - both those of customers and Microsoft's own. Google subsidiary Wiz found a flaw in the database's Gremlin API, usually used for storing and managing property graph data. If bad actors h...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4203921/microsoft-almost-gave-away-the-keys-to-everyones-azure-cosmos-dbs.html>

08. Three Recent Chrome Releases Fix 1,442 Flaws, More Than Prior 23 Updates Combined

Google on Thursday announced that it fixed a whopping 1,072 security bugs in Chrome versions 149 and 150, surpassing the total number of flaws the company fixed across the prior 23 milestones combined. Both versions were released last month. In its latest patch for Chrome 151, released Wednesday, the tech giant resolved 370 flaws, out of which 349 were repo...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/three-recent-chrome-releases-fix-1442.html>

09. Criminals used AI and children's coding software to build a multimillion-dollar ad fraud empire

A security investigation into inexpensive Android TV boxes led researchers to an ad fraud operation that had remained unnoticed for several years. Fuyao apps ecosystem (Source: Bitsight) According to Bitsight, the operation, named Fuyao, uses preinstalled Android apps, device identity spoofing, AI-generated websites, and residential proxy services to genera...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/31/fuyao-ad-fraud-botnet-android-tv-boxes/>

10. Researchers Report 84 Flaws in 4G and 5G Cores, Including a Session Hijacking Flaw

An academic study has disclosed a "widespread class" of security vulnerabilities impacting 4G and 5G core networks that, if successfully exploited, could trigger denial-of-service (DoS) attacks and even session hijacking, allowing an attacker to seize control of a user's network session. The findings have been released by a group of researchers from Singapo...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/researchers-report-84-flaws-in-4g-and.html>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Fuyao operation uses Android TV boxes for ad fraud

Bitsight researchers uncovered the operation by monitoring an expired domain used for factory backdoors and telemetry.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/fuyao-operation-uses-android-tv-boxes-for-ad-fraud>

02. AI chatbots outperform humans in building trust for scams

Researchers from four universities conducted a study pitting AI chatbots against human scammers in a simulation of "pig butchering" scams, a form of romance scam that escalates to fake cryptocurrency investments.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ai-chatbots-outperform-humans-in-building-trust-for-scams>

03. Amgen says cloud data breach exposed patient health, proprietary info

Pharmaceutical company Amgen says it suffered a data breach after threat actors stole corporate data and patient information stored in multiple cloud systems operated by third-party service providers. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/amgen-says-cloud-data-breach-exposed-patient-health-proprietary-info/>

04. Rogue AI, the Bar, Breaches, BMC, Hugging Face, Helmuth von Multke, Ike, Shieldfont, - SWN #603

Rogue AI, the Bar, Breaches, BMC, Hugging Face, Helmuth von Multke, Ike, Shieldfont, - SWN #603

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/podcast-segment/15060-rogue-ai-the-bar-breaches-bmc-hugging-face-helmuth-von-multke-ike-shieldfont-swn-603>

05. Fake Fortnite rewards are stealing players' accounts

Scammers are using fake V-Bucks offers and locker value sites to hijack Fortnite accounts.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/07/fake-fortnite-rewards-are-stealing-players-accounts>

06. What we learned about zero-trust from the OpenAI breach of HuggingFace

Here's why in a world where AI models can hack other companies, we have to outreason our adversaries.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/perspective/what-we-learned-about-zero-trust-from-the-openai-breach-of-huggingface>

07. The Good, the Bad and the Ugly in Cybersecurity - Week 31

Police flag 4,000 URLs to disrupt The Com, theft victims sue Apple over a \$1.8M wallet scam, and OpenAI and Anthropic models reach real systems in cyber tests.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/the-good-the-bad-and-the-ugly-in-cybersecurity-week-31-8/>

08. Cybercrime goes subscription: AI, malware and infrastructure on demand

Cybercrime has become a commercialized ecosystem where criminals can buy or rent nearly every capability needed to launch sophisticated attacks. These services provide anonymity, plausible deniability, and access to short-lived infrastructure that is difficult to detect, attribute, and disrupt, enabling low-skilled actors to operate at scale, according to t...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/31/infoblox-domain-abuse-campaigns-report/>

09. [+24h Old] Anthropic Reveals Claude Escaped Testing, Breaching Three Companies

Anthropic has revealed that Claude AI models compromised third-party organizations

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/anthropic-claude-breached-three/>

10. [+24h Old] CareCloud Data Breach Impacts Over 350,000

In March 2026, hackers stole personal, financial, and medical information from the company's AWS environment. The post CareCloud Data Breach Impacts Over 350,000 appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/carecloud-data-breach-impacts-over-350000/>